

D823

Product Management and Leadership

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

The head of sales at a payroll software company, who closed the firm's largest deal last year, tells the new product manager to build a chatbot because "customers want AI." No customer problem has been named. What should the PM do first?

- A. Investigate what customer problem the chatbot would solve and whether it is worth solving.
- B. Refuse all feature requests from sales.
- C. Add the chatbot to the next sprint.
- D. Build it because the sales head has a strong track record.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A team believes busy parents will pay \$15 a month for weekly meal plans. Its office has a rooftop garden. Engineers estimate six months to build the full app. What is the best MVP?

- A. A polished app with half the features.
- B. A landing page with a sign-up and payment offer, with plans sent manually by email to those who pay.
- C. A survey asking if parents like meal plans.
- D. Build the full app in six months, then launch.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An MVP test shows that only 1% of visitors paid, far below the 10% the team needed. What is the right conclusion?

- A. The MVP failed and was a waste.
- B. Lower the target to 1% and proceed.
- C. Build the full product; the MVP was too small to count.
- D. The key assumption did not hold; pivot or revise before investing in a full build.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A PM at a note-taking app with a purple logo scores three features. A: reach 2,000, impact 2, confidence 80%, effort 4. B: reach 5,000, impact 1, confidence 50%, effort 2. C: reach 1,000, impact 3, confidence 100%, effort 2. Which has the highest RICE score?

- A. C (1,500)
- B. B (2,500)
- C. B, because it has the largest reach.
- D. A (3,200)

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A feature has a RICE score of 600, reach of 1,500, impact of 2, and confidence of 80%. What effort (person-months) was used?

- A. 2
- B. 5
- C. 4
- D. 0.25

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

6.

A fitness app, promoted by a celebrity trainer, got 200,000 downloads in its first month. After 30 days, 4% of users are still active, and few say they would miss it. Does it have product-market fit?

- A. Yes; 200,000 downloads prove fit.
- B. Fit cannot be measured.
- C. Yes, because a celebrity endorses it.
- D. Not yet; low retention shows users are not getting lasting value.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

7.

A 12-year-old email marketing product, whose team recently moved to a four-day week, has slowing growth, many similar competitors, and most target customers already using some tool. Which strategy fits its lifecycle stage?

- A. Introduction: build awareness of the category.
- B. Growth: spend heavily to acquire new users.
- C. Maturity: differentiate, defend share, and improve margins.
- D. Decline: retire it immediately.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A product's sales are falling each year as customers move to a new technology. Which strategy best fits?

- A. Launch awareness campaigns for the category.
- B. Harvest profits, cut costs, and plan to reposition or retire it.
- C. Keep the same plan used at launch.
- D. Increase acquisition spending to regain growth.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A large customer sees “Offline mode — Q3” on a public roadmap slide with a colorful timeline and tells its board the feature ships July 1. The team has not started discovery. What should the PM change?

- A. Put the full requirements spec on the slide.
- B. Remove the roadmap and share nothing.
- C. Commit to July 1 to keep the customer happy.
- D. Frame the roadmap around themes and outcomes with time horizons, and state that items are not commitments.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A product manager with an MBA insists engineers use a specific database, while the tech lead says it cannot scale. The PM also set the quarter's goal of cutting onboarding time in half. Who should decide the database?

- A.** The PM, because PMs are the team's boss.
- B.** The PM, because of the MBA.
- C.** The engineering team, since the PM owns the goal and engineering owns how to achieve it.
- D.** The customer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A PM at a budgeting app with a sleek dark theme reports "500,000 total sign-ups since launch" as the quarter's success. Weekly active users fell 15%. Which metric better guides decisions?

- A.** App store page views.
- B.** Weekly active users and retention.
- C.** Number of features shipped.
- D.** Total sign-ups since launch.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which sign best shows that a number is a vanity metric?

- A.** It can only go up and does not change any decision.
- B.** It is measured weekly.
- C.** Any metric shown to executives.
- D.** It is tied to revenue.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

The head of sales at a payroll software company, ~~who closed the firm's largest deal last year~~, tells the new product manager to build a chatbot because "customers want AI." No customer problem has been named. What should the PM do first?

Target word: first PM step **Decides:** No validated problem exists.

A	Correct	Validate the problem before the solution.
B	Absolute language	Sales input is useful; it needs validation.
C	Inverted operation	Starts with the solution.
D	Camouflage	Track record does not validate the need.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A team believes busy parents will pay \$15 a month for weekly meal plans. ~~Its office has a rooftop garden.~~ Engineers estimate six months to build the full app. What is the best MVP?

Target word: choose MVP **Decides:** Riskiest assumption: willingness to pay.

A	Adjacent category	A smaller release, not a learning experiment.
B	Correct	Tests willingness to pay with little build.
C	Confusion set	Stated interest is weaker evidence than payment.
D	Dropped element	No early learning.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

An MVP test shows that only 1% of visitors paid, far below the 10% the team needed. What is the right conclusion?

Target word: interpret MVP result **Decides:** The assumption is invalidated; pivot or rethink.

A	Absolute language	Learning cheaply is the success of an MVP.
B	Wrong stem number	Moves the goalposts.
C	Inverted operation	Ignores the evidence.
D	Correct	The MVP delivered its learning.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A PM at a note-taking app ~~with a purple logo~~ scores three features. A: reach 2,000, impact 2, confidence 80%, effort 4. B: reach 5,000, impact 1, confidence 50%, effort 2. C: reach 1,000, impact 3, confidence 100%, effort 2. Which has the highest RICE score?

Target word: highest RICE **Decides:** A = 800, B = 1,250, C = 1,500.

A	Correct	$1,000 \times 3 \times 1.0 / 2 = 1,500$, above B's 1,250 and A's 800.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out the 50% confidence.
C	Wrong stem number	Reach is one input, not the score.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out effort: $2,000 \times 2 \times 0.8 = 3,200$ before dividing by 4.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A feature has a RICE score of 600, reach of 1,500, impact of 2, and confidence of 80%. What effort (person-months) was used?

Target word: solve for effort **Decides:** $\text{Effort} = (R \times I \times C) / \text{score}$.

A	Wrong stem number	The impact score.
B	Dropped element	$3,000 / 600$ leaves out confidence.
C	Correct	$1,500 \times 2 \times 0.8 = 2,400$; $2,400 / 600 = 4$.
D	Inverted operation	$600 / 2,400$ flips the division.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A fitness app, ~~promoted by a celebrity trainer~~, got 200,000 downloads in its first month. After 30 days, 4% of users are still active, and few say they would miss it. Does it have product-market fit?

Target word: judge product-market fit **Decides:** Retention is weak.

A	Wrong stem number	Acquisition is not retention.
B	Absolute language	Retention and surveys give strong signals.
C	Camouflage	Promotion drives downloads, not fit.
D	Correct	Fit shows in retention and disappointment at loss.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A 12-year-old email marketing product, ~~whose team recently moved to a four-day week~~, has slowing growth, many similar competitors, and most target customers already using some tool. Which strategy fits its lifecycle stage?

Target word: strategy by stage **Decides:** Saturation and slow growth = maturity.

A	Confusion set	The category is already well known.
B	Adjacent category	Few new users remain to acquire.
C	Correct	Matches a saturated, slow-growth market.
D	Absolute language	Slowing growth is not decline, and retirement is not automatic.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A product's sales are falling each year as customers move to a new technology. Which strategy best fits?

Target word: strategy for decline **Decides:** Falling sales from substitution = decline.

A	Confusion set	An introduction-stage tactic.
B	Correct	Decline strategies protect cash and plan the exit.
C	Dropped element	Ignores the stage.
D	Inverted operation	A growth tactic in a shrinking market.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A large customer sees “Offline mode — Q3” on a public roadmap slide ~~with a colorful timeline~~ and tells its board the feature ships July 1. The team has not started discovery. What should the PM change?

Target word: roadmap purpose **Decides:** Roadmaps show themes and outcomes, not promises.

A	Adjacent category	Specs belong in requirements docs.
B	Absolute language	Roadmaps are valuable when framed correctly.
C	Inverted operation	Turns a direction into a promise before discovery.
D	Correct	Roadmaps show direction, not dated promises.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A product manager ~~with an MBA~~ insists engineers use a specific database, while the tech lead says it cannot scale. The PM also set the quarter’s goal of cutting onboarding time in half. Who should decide the database?

Target word: decision rights **Decides:** How is engineering’s call.

A	Inverted operation	PMs lead by influence.
B	Camouflage	Credentials do not shift decision rights.
C	Correct	Separates why/what from how.
D	Adjacent category	Customers inform the problem, not technical design.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A PM at a budgeting app ~~with a sleek dark theme~~ reports “500,000 total sign-ups since launch” as the quarter’s success. Weekly active users fell 15%. Which metric better guides decisions?

Target word: actionable metric **Decides:** Active use reflects ongoing value.

A	Confusion set	Another vanity metric.
B	Correct	Reflect ongoing value and can guide action.
C	Adjacent category	An output, not customer value.
D	Inverted operation	A vanity metric that only rises.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

Which sign best shows that a number is a vanity metric?

Target word: reverse: define by property **Decides:** Cannot fall and does not guide action.

A	Correct	Cumulative totals look good but inform nothing.
B	Adjacent category	Frequency does not define vanity.
C	Absolute language	Audience does not decide it.
D	Inverted operation	Revenue ties are a mark of actionable metrics.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Problem before solution	Product work starts by validating a customer problem worth solving and the outcome it should change, before committing to features.	Treating a stakeholder's feature request as a validated requirement.	A request that names a feature but not the problem it solves.
2	MVP tests the riskiest assumption	A minimum viable product is the smallest experiment that produces validated learning about the riskiest assumption.	Treating the MVP as a stripped-down first release or a low-quality product.	"What's the least we can build to learn whether...?"
3	RICE prioritization	RICE score = (Reach × Impact × Confidence) / Effort; higher is better.	Leaving out confidence or effort, so the biggest reach always wins.	Reach, impact, confidence, and effort figures for competing items.
4	Product-market fit shows in retention	Product-market fit is evidenced by users who keep coming back and would be disappointed to lose the product, not by sign-ups alone.	Reading a spike in downloads or sign-ups as fit.	Strong acquisition with weak retention.
5	Strategy follows the lifecycle stage	Introduction: build awareness and learn; growth: scale and win share; maturity: defend, differentiate, and optimize margin; decline: harvest, reposition, or retire.	Using the same strategy at every stage, such as heavy acquisition spending in decline.	Sales growth rate, competition, and market saturation.
6	Roadmaps communicate outcomes and priorities	A product roadmap shows strategic themes and intended outcomes over time; detailed specs live in requirements and backlogs.	Treating the roadmap as a fixed, dated list of features.	A stakeholder treating a roadmap item as a promised ship date.
7	PM owns the why and what	The product manager owns the problem, goals, and priorities (why and what); engineering and design own how; PMs lead by influence, not authority.	PMs dictating technical implementation or acting as the team's boss.	A dispute over who decides architecture vs. priority.
8	Actionable vs. vanity metrics	Useful metrics tie to customer value and business outcomes and can guide decisions (activation, retention, revenue per user); vanity metrics look good but do not guide action.	Reporting cumulative sign-ups or page views as proof of success.	A number that only ever goes up.

Course scope (public description): Product Management and Leadership provides a comprehensive introduction to core product management concepts and processes. It covers frameworks for taking products from ideation through development, launch and lifecycle management, with a focus on delivering customer and business value. By completing this course, learners establish critical knowledge and abilities to strategically lead products from initial conception through successful launch and drive business growth.